

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Cyber Security, CII and Cybercrime - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies CIA security triad?

A. Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. B. A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. C. Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. D. Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent.

Answer: A. Explanation: Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q2. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of CIA security triad?

A. A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. B. Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. C. Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. D. Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure.

Answer: B. Explanation: Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q3. Which statement uses CIA security triad without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. B. Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. C. Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. D. Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime.

Answer: C. Explanation: Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CIA security triad?

A. Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime. B. Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. C. Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. D. Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three.

Answer: D. Explanation: Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Risk-chain grammar?

A. Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. B. Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. C. Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. D. A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation.

Answer: A. Explanation: Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q6. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Risk-chain grammar?

A. Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime. B. Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. C. Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. D. Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure.

Answer: B. Explanation: Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q7. Which statement uses Risk-chain grammar without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. B. Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. C. Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. D. Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime.

Answer: C. Explanation: Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Risk-chain grammar?

A. Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. B. Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. C. Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime. D. Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent.

Answer: D. Explanation: Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Cyber-incident chain?

A. A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. B. Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime. C. Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. D. Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication.

Answer: A. Explanation: A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q10. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Cyber-incident chain?

A. Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. B. A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. C. Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. D. Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime.

Answer: B. Explanation: A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q11. Which statement uses Cyber-incident chain without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. B. Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. C. A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. D. Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime.

Answer: C. Explanation: A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Cyber-incident chain?

A. Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. B. Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. C. Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. D. A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation.

Answer: D. Explanation: A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Cybercrime chain?

A. Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. B. Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. C. Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime. D. Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult.

Answer: A. Explanation: Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q14. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Cybercrime chain?

A. Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. B. Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. C. Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime. D. Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult.

Answer: B. Explanation: Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q15. Which statement uses Cybercrime chain without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. B. Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. C. Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. D. Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety.

Answer: C. Explanation: Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Cybercrime chain?

A. Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. B. Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. C. Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. D. Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication.

Answer: D. Explanation: Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Cyber-warfare boundary?

A. Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. B. Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. C. Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime. D. Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult.

Answer: A. Explanation: Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q18. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Cyber-warfare boundary?

A. Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. B. Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. C. Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. D. Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult.

Answer: B. Explanation: Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q19. Which statement uses Cyber-warfare boundary without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. B. Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. C. Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. D. Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience.

Answer: C. Explanation: Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Cyber-warfare boundary?

A. Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. B. Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. C. Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. D. Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure.

Answer: D. Explanation: Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary run or implementation status.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Cyber-terrorism law?

A. Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime. B. Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. C. Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. D. Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience.

Answer: A. Explanation: Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary run or implementation status.

Q22. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Cyber-terrorism law?

A. Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. B. Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime. C. Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. D. Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety.

Answer: B. Explanation: Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary run or implementation status.

Q23. Which statement uses Cyber-terrorism law without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. B. Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. C. Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime. D. Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime.

Answer: C. Explanation: Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary

rung or implementation status.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Cyber-terrorism law?

A. The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. B. Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. C. Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. D. Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime.

Answer: D. Explanation: Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Attribution discipline?

A. Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. B. Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. C. Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. D. Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety.

Answer: A. Explanation: Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q26. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Attribution discipline?

A. Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. B. Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. C. Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. D. Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime.

Answer: B. Explanation: Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q27. Which statement uses Attribution discipline without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. B. The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. C. Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. D. Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities.

Answer: C. Explanation: Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution

difficult. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Attribution discipline?

A. Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. B. Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. C. The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. D. Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult.

Answer: D. Explanation: Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies CII definition?

A. Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. B. Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. C. Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. D. Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience.

Answer: A. Explanation: Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q30. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of CII definition?

A. Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. B. Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. C. The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. D. Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities.

Answer: B. Explanation: Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q31. Which statement uses CII definition without changing its institution, law or status?

A. The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. B. Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. C. Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. D. Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime.

Answer: C. Explanation: Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CII definition?

A. CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. B. Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. C. The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. D. Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety.

Answer: D. Explanation: Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Protected-system boundary?

A. Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. B. Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. C. The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. D. Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities.

Answer: A. Explanation: Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q34. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Protected-system boundary?

A. Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. B. Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. C. The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. D. Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body.

Answer: B. Explanation: Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q35. Which statement uses Protected-system boundary without changing its institution, law or status?

A. CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. B. Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. C. Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. D. The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles.

Answer: C. Explanation: Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Protected-system boundary?

A. Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. B. CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. C. Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. D. Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience.

Answer: D. Explanation: Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies NCIIPC mandate?

A. Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. B. The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. C. Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. D. Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body.

Answer: A. Explanation: Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q38. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of NCIIPC mandate?

A. Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. B. Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. C. The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. D. CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution.

Answer: B. Explanation: Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q39. Which statement uses NCIIPC mandate without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. B. Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. C. Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. D. CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution.

Answer: C. Explanation: Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NCIIPC mandate?

A. Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in *Shreya Singhal v. Union of India* in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence. B. Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. C. CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. D. Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities.

Answer: D. Explanation: Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies CERT-In mandate?

A. Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. B. CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. C. The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. D. Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body.

Answer: A. Explanation: Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every

cybercrime. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q42. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of CERT-In mandate?

A. Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. B. Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. C. CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. D. Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body.

Answer: B. Explanation: Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q43. Which statement uses CERT-In mandate without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in Shreya Singhal v. Union of India in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence. B. CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. C. Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. D. Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure.

Answer: C. Explanation: Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CERT-In mandate?

A. CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. B. Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in Shreya Singhal v. Union of India in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence. C. Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. D. Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime.

Answer: D. Explanation: Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies I4C mandate boundary?

A. The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. B. CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. C. Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. D. Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q46. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of I4C mandate boundary?

A. CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. B. The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. C. Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in Shreya Singhal v. Union of India in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence. D. Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q47. Which statement uses I4C mandate boundary without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in Shreya Singhal v. Union of India in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence. B. Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. C. The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. D. CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about I4C mandate boundary?

A. CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. B. Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in Shreya Singhal v. Union of India in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence. C. The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. D. The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Sectoral-regulator layer?

A. Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. B. Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. C. CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. D. Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in Shreya Singhal v. Union of India in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence.

Answer: A. Explanation: Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q50. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Sectoral-regulator layer?

A. CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. B. Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. C. Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in Shreya Singhal v. Union of India in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence. D. Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure.

Answer: B. Explanation: Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q51. Which statement uses Sectoral-regulator layer without changing its institution, law or status?

A. CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. B. The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. C. Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. D. Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in Shreya Singhal v. Union of India in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence.

Answer: C. Explanation: Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Sectoral-regulator layer?

A. CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. B. A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. C. The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. D. Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body.

Answer: D. Explanation: Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national

body. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies CERT-In directions?

A. CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. B. Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in *Shreya Singhal v. Union of India* in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence. C. CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. D. Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure.

Answer: A. Explanation: CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q54. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of CERT-In directions?

A. CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. B. CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. C. The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. D. Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in *Shreya Singhal v. Union of India* in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence.

Answer: B. Explanation: CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q55. Which statement uses CERT-In directions without changing its institution, law or status?

A. The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. B. A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. C. CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. D. CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture.

Answer: C. Explanation: CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CERT-In directions?

A. A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. B. Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. C. The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. D. CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution.

Answer: D. Explanation: CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies IT Act powers map?

A. Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. B. Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in Shreya Singhal v. Union of India in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence. C. CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. D. The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation.

Answer: A. Explanation: Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q58. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of IT Act powers map?

A. A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. B. Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. C. CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. D. The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation.

Answer: B. Explanation: Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q59. Which statement uses IT Act powers map without changing its institution, law or status?

A. The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. B. Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. C. Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. D. A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs.

Answer: C. Explanation: Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about IT Act powers map?

A. A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. B. Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. C. Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. D. Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure.

Answer: D. Explanation: Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Section 66A status?

A. Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in *Shreya Singhal v. Union of India* in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence. B. CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. C. A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. D. The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation.

Answer: A. Explanation: Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in *Shreya Singhal v. Union of India* in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q62. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Section 66A status?

A. The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. B. Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in *Shreya Singhal v. Union of India* in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence. C. A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. D. Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards.

Answer: B. Explanation: Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in *Shreya Singhal v. Union of India* in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q63. Which statement uses Section 66A status without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. B. Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. C. Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in *Shreya Singhal v. Union of India* in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence. D. A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs.

Answer: C. Explanation: Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in Shreya Singhal v. Union of India in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Section 66A status?

A. Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. B. Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. C. Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. D. Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in Shreya Singhal v. Union of India in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence.

Answer: D. Explanation: Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in Shreya Singhal v. Union of India in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies CyberDome role?

A. CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. B. Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. C. A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. D. The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation.

Answer: A. Explanation: CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q66. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of CyberDome role?

A. Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. B. CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. C. A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. D. Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three.

Answer: B. Explanation: CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q67. Which statement uses CyberDome role without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. B. Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. C. CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. D. Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three.

Answer: C. Explanation: CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CyberDome role?

A. Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. B. A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. C. Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. D. CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture.

Answer: D. Explanation: CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies DPDP boundary and phases?

A. The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. B. A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. C. Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. D. Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards.

Answer: A. Explanation: The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q70. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of DPDP boundary and phases?

A. Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. B. The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. C. Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. D. Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three.

Answer: B. Explanation: The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered

commencement rather than full same-day operation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q71. Which statement uses DPDP boundary and phases without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. B. A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. C. The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. D. Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three.

Answer: C. Explanation: The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about DPDP boundary and phases?

A. Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. B. A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. C. Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. D. The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation.

Answer: D. Explanation: The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Evidence-status firewall?

A. A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. B. Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. C. Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. D. Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent.

Answer: A. Explanation: A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q74. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Evidence-status firewall?

A. Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. B. A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. C. Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. D. A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation.

Answer: B. Explanation: A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q75. Which statement uses Evidence-status firewall without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. B. Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. C. A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. D. A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation.

Answer: C. Explanation: A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Evidence-status firewall?

A. Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. B. Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. C. A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. D. A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs.

Answer: D. Explanation: A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Resilience-first end-state?

A. Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. B. Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. C. Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. D. A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation.

Answer: A. Explanation: Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. The other options change the threat category,

institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q78. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Resilience-first end-state?

A. Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. B. Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. C. Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. D. A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation.

Answer: B. Explanation: Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q79. Which statement uses Resilience-first end-state without changing its institution, law or status?

A. A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. B. Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. C. Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. D. Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication.

Answer: C. Explanation: Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Resilience-first end-state?

A. Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. B. Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime. C. Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. D. Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards.

Answer: D. Explanation: Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

AUDITED TOPIC-SPECIFIC PYQ OWNERSHIP

The audited ledgers route the 2019 CyberDome, 2020 cybercrime-types, 2021 cross-border cyber-attack and 2022 cyber-elements/strategy demands here. The three conservative cards cover 2019, 2021 and 2022; OCR inspection confirmed the 2019 and 2021 printed stems, while the ledger records official-scan verification for 2022.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-III

Demand: What CyberDome is and how it can help control internet crimes in India.

Status: Printed stem inspected in the OCR-searchable official paper; Explain · 10 marks · 150 words.

Model solution: Cyber-incident chain: A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation.

Cybercrime chain: Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. **CERT-In mandate:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **I4C mandate boundary:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Sectoral-regulator layer:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **CyberDome role:** CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. **Evidence-status firewall:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Resilience-first end-state:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-III', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Cyber-incident chain: A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Cybercrime chain:** Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. **CERT-In mandate:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **I4C mandate boundary:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Sectoral-regulator layer:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **CyberDome role:** CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. **Evidence-status firewall:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Resilience-first end-state:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Demand: What CyberDome is and how it can help control internet crimes in India. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response

route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

2. **Claim:** Status: Printed stem inspected in the OCR-searchable official paper; Explain · 10 marks · 150 words.

Named evidence/example: Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Cyber-incident chain: A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Cybercrime chain:** Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. **CERT-In mandate:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **I4C mandate boundary:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Sectoral-regulator layer:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **CyberDome role:** CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. **Evidence-status firewall:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs.

Resilience-first end-state: Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-III', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2021 GS-III

Demand: Impact of cross-border cyber attacks on India's internal security and defensive measures against sophisticated attacks.

Status: Printed stem inspected in the OCR-searchable official paper; Analyse/Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words.

Model solution: CIA security triad: Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. **Risk-chain grammar:** Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. **Cyber-incident chain:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Cyber-warfare boundary:** Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. **Attribution discipline:** Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal

and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. **CII definition:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety.

NCIIPC mandate: Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **CERT-In mandate:**

Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Sectoral-regulator layer:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Evidence-status firewall:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Resilience-first end-state:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2021 GS-III', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: CIA security triad: Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. **Risk-chain grammar:** Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. **Cyber-incident chain:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Cyber-warfare boundary:** Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. **Attribution discipline:** Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. **CII definition:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety.

NCIIPC mandate: Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **CERT-In mandate:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Sectoral-regulator layer:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Evidence-status firewall:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Resilience-first end-state:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Demand: Impact of cross-border cyber attacks on India's internal security and defensive measures against sophisticated attacks. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** Status: Printed stem inspected in the OCR-searchable official paper; Analyse/Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction,

source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: CIA security triad: Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. **Risk-chain grammar:** Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. **Cyber-incident chain:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Cyber-warfare boundary:** Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. **Attribution discipline:** Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. **CII definition:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **NCIIPC mandate:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **CERT-In mandate:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Sectoral-regulator layer:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Evidence-status firewall:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Resilience-first end-state:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2021 GS-III', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 GS-III

Demand: Elements and challenges of cyber security and the extent to which India has developed a comprehensive National Cyber Security Strategy.

Status: The routing ledger records official-scan verification; Examine · 15 marks · 250 words.

Model solution: CIA security triad: Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. **Risk-chain grammar:** Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. **Cyber-incident chain:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Cybercrime chain:** Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. **Cyber-warfare boundary:** Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. **CII definition:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that

incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **NCIIPC mandate:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **CERT-In mandate:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **I4C mandate boundary:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Sectoral-regulator layer:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **CERT-In directions:** CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. **DPDP boundary and phases:** The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. **Evidence-status firewall:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Resilience-first end-state:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 GS-III', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: CIA security triad: Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. **Risk-chain grammar:** Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. **Cyber-incident chain:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Cybercrime chain:** Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. **Cyber-warfare boundary:** Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. **CII definition:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **NCIIPC mandate:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **CERT-In mandate:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **I4C mandate boundary:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Sectoral-regulator layer:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **CERT-In directions:** CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. **DPDP boundary and phases:** The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. **Evidence-status firewall:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Resilience-first end-state:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Demand: Elements and challenges of cyber security and the extent to which India has developed a comprehensive National Cyber Security Strategy. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** Status: The routing ledger records official-scan verification; Examine · 15 marks · 250 words. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: CIA security triad: Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. **Risk-chain grammar:** Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. **Cyber-incident chain:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Cybercrime chain:** Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. **Cyber-warfare boundary:** Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. **CII definition:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **NCIIPC mandate:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **CERT-In mandate:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **I4C mandate boundary:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Sectoral-regulator layer:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **CERT-In directions:** CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. **DPDP boundary and phases:** The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. **Evidence-status firewall:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Resilience-first end-state:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 GS-III', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish a cyber incident from a cybercrime and explain the correct institutional response chain. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: CIA security triad. **Named evidence/example:** Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Risk-chain grammar. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cyber-incident chain. **Named evidence/example:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cybercrime chain. **Named evidence/example:** Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** I4C mandate boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three.
- Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent.
- A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation.
- Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication.
- Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime.

- The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles.
- A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: CIA security triad. **Named evidence/example:** Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three.

Analysis: This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Risk-chain grammar. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cyber-incident chain. **Named evidence/example:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cybercrime chain. **Named evidence/example:** Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** I4C mandate boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on 'Distinguish a cyber incident from a cybercrime and explain the correct institutional response...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: CIA security triad. **Named evidence/example:** Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three.

Analysis: This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Risk-chain grammar. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cyber-incident chain. **Named evidence/example:** A cyber incident is a technical security event

handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cybercrime chain. **Named evidence/example:** Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** I4C mandate boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
3. **Claim:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
4. **Claim:** Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
5. **Claim:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response

route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

6. **Claim:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
7. **Claim:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: CIA security triad. **Named evidence/example:** Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Risk-chain grammar. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cyber-incident chain. **Named evidence/example:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cybercrime chain. **Named evidence/example:** Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** I4C mandate boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Distinguish a cyber incident from a cybercrime and explain the correct institutional response...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain CyberDome's utility and limits as a State-level collaborative model. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Cyber-incident chain. **Named evidence/example:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cybercrime chain. **Named evidence/example:** Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** I4C mandate boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sectoral-regulator layer. **Named evidence/example:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CyberDome role. **Named evidence/example:** CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation.
- Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication.
- The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles.

- Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body.
- CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture.
- A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Cyber-incident chain. **Named evidence/example:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cybercrime chain. **Named evidence/example:** Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** I4C mandate boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sectoral-regulator layer. **Named evidence/example:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CyberDome role. **Named evidence/example:** CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on 'Explain CyberDome's utility and limits as a State-level collaborative model. Answer in about...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Cyber-incident chain. **Named evidence/example:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cybercrime chain. **Named evidence/example:** Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** I4C mandate boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:**

The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sectoral-regulator layer. **Named evidence/example:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CyberDome role. **Named evidence/example:** CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
3. **Claim:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
4. **Claim:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
5. **Claim:** CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
6. **Claim:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status

anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Cyber-incident chain. **Named evidence/example:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cybercrime chain. **Named evidence/example:** Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** I4C mandate boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sectoral-regulator layer. **Named evidence/example:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CyberDome role. **Named evidence/example:** CyberDome is Kerala Police's collaborative cyber-security and cybercrime support initiative for expertise, research, forensics, awareness and police capacity; a State model is not the national incident-response architecture. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Explain CyberDome's utility and limits as a State-level collaborative model. Answer in about...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Analyse the impact of cross-border cyber attacks on internal security and propose defensive measures. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** CIA security triad. **Named evidence/example:** Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Risk-chain grammar. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cyber-incident chain. **Named evidence/example:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cyber-warfare boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Attribution discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CII definition. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCIIPC mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sectoral-regulator layer. **Named evidence/example:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Resilience-first end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the

policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three.
- Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent.
- A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation.
- Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure.
- Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult.
- Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety.
- Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities.
- Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime.
- Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body.
- A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs.
- Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: CIA security triad. **Named evidence/example:** Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three.

Analysis: This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Risk-chain grammar. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:**

The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cyber-incident chain. **Named evidence/example:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cyber-warfare boundary.

Named evidence/example: Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure.

Analysis: This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Attribution discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CII definition. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information

Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCIIPC mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sectoral-regulator layer. **Named evidence/example:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Resilience-first end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **analyse** requires a direct position on 'Analyse the impact of cross-border cyber attacks on internal security and propose defensive...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** CIA security triad. **Named evidence/example:** Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Risk-chain grammar. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cyber-incident chain. **Named evidence/example:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cyber-warfare boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Attribution discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised

infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CII definition. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCIIPC mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sectoral-regulator layer. **Named evidence/example:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Resilience-first end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
3. **Claim:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

4. **Claim:** Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
5. **Claim:** Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
6. **Claim:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
7. **Claim:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
8. **Claim:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
9. **Claim:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
10. **Claim:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
11. **Claim:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: CIA security triad. **Named evidence/example:** Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three.

Analysis: This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Risk-chain grammar. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cyber-incident chain. **Named evidence/example:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cyber-warfare boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber warfare refers to state-linked strategic cyber activity against another state; political attribution requires evidence beyond technical indicators and is not established merely by origin infrastructure. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Attribution discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CII definition. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCIIIPC mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sectoral-regulator layer. **Named evidence/example:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Resilience-first end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Analyse the impact of cross-border cyber attacks on internal security and propose defensive...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine India's institutional architecture for Critical Information Infrastructure protection and cybercrime response. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** CII definition. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Protected-system boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCIIIPC mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** I4C mandate boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sectoral-regulator layer. **Named evidence/example:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In directions. **Named evidence/example:** CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: Resilience-first end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety.
- Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience.
- Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities.
- Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime.
- The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles.
- Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body.
- CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution.
- A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs.
- Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** CII definition. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Protected-system boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCIIIPC mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** I4C mandate boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sectoral-regulator layer. **Named evidence/example:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience

responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body.

Analysis: This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In directions. **Named evidence/example:** CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Resilience-first end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on 'Examine India's institutional architecture for Critical Information Infrastructure protection...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** CII definition. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Protected-system boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCIIIPC mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** I4C mandate boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sectoral-regulator layer. **Named evidence/example:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In directions. **Named evidence/example:** CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or

being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Resilience-first end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
3. **Claim:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
4. **Claim:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
5. **Claim:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
6. **Claim:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

7. **Claim:** CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
8. **Claim:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
9. **Claim:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: CII definition. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Protected-system boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCIIIPC mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** I4C mandate boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sectoral-regulator layer. **Named evidence/example:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In directions. **Named evidence/example:** CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or

being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Resilience-first end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Examine India's institutional architecture for Critical Information Infrastructure protection...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Critically assess whether India's cyber-security architecture amounts to a comprehensive national strategy. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** CIA security triad. **Named evidence/example:** Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Risk-chain grammar. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Attribution discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CII definition. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCIIIPC mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every

cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** I4C mandate boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sectoral-regulator layer. **Named evidence/example:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In directions. **Named evidence/example:** CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** IT Act powers map. **Named evidence/example:** Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** DPDP boundary and phases. **Named evidence/example:** The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Resilience-first end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three.
- Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent.
- Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult.
- Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety.
- Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities.
- Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime.

- The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles.
- Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body.
- CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution.
- Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure.
- The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation.
- A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs.
- Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: CIA security triad. **Named evidence/example:** Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three.

Analysis: This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Risk-chain grammar. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Attribution discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CII definition. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCIIIPC mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** I4C mandate boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sectoral-regulator layer. **Named evidence/example:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body.

Analysis: This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In directions. **Named evidence/example:** CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** IT Act powers map. **Named evidence/example:** Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** DPDP boundary and phases. **Named evidence/example:** The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Resilience-first end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **critically assess** requires a direct position on 'Critically assess whether India's cyber-security architecture amounts to a comprehensive...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** CIA security triad. **Named evidence/example:** Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Risk-chain grammar. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Attribution discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CII definition. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCIIIPC mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument,

institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** I4C mandate boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sectoral-regulator layer. **Named evidence/example:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In directions. **Named evidence/example:** CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** IT Act powers map. **Named evidence/example:** Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** DPDP boundary and phases. **Named evidence/example:** The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Resilience-first end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal

character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

3. **Claim:** Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
4. **Claim:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
5. **Claim:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
6. **Claim:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
7. **Claim:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
8. **Claim:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
9. **Claim:** CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
10. **Claim:** Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
11. **Claim:** The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather

than full same-day operation. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

12. **Claim:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

13. **Claim:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: CIA security triad. **Named evidence/example:** Cybersecurity seeks to preserve confidentiality, integrity and availability of information and systems; an event may affect one, two or all three.

Analysis: This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Risk-chain grammar. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber risk arises when a threat actor or event exploits a vulnerability and produces a consequence; policy can reduce exposure, vulnerability, impact and recovery time without eliminating hostile intent. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Attribution discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Cyber attribution is graded across technical, operational, legal and political assessments; shared tools, compromised infrastructure and false flags make confident public attribution difficult. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CII definition. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCIIPC mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** I4C mandate boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified

evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sectoral-regulator layer. **Named evidence/example:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In directions. **Named evidence/example:** CERT-In's Directions dated 28 April 2022 require specified cyber incidents to be reported within six hours of noticing them or being informed; reporting is an incident-response input, not proof of attribution. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** IT Act powers map. **Named evidence/example:** Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** DPDP boundary and phases. **Named evidence/example:** The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Resilience-first end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Critically assess whether India's cyber-security architecture amounts to a comprehensive...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate the relationship among cybersecurity, CII protection, cybercrime enforcement and personal-data governance. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Cyber-incident chain. **Named evidence/example:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cybercrime chain. **Named evidence/example:** Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat

category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication.

Qualification: The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cyber-terrorism law. **Named evidence/example:** Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CII definition. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Protected-system boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCIIPC mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** I4C mandate boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sectoral-regulator layer. **Named evidence/example:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** IT Act powers map. **Named evidence/example:** Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Section 66A status. **Named evidence/example:** Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in *Shreya Singhal v. Union of India* in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** DPDP boundary and phases. **Named evidence/example:** The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date,

institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Resilience-first end-state.

Named evidence/example: Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation.
- Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication.
- Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime.
- Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety.
- Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience.
- Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities.
- Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime.
- The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles.
- Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body.
- Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure.
- Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in *Shreya Singhal v. Union of India* in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence.
- The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation.
- A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs.
- Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Cyber-incident chain. **Named evidence/example:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cybercrime chain. **Named evidence/example:** Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cyber-terrorism law. **Named evidence/example:** Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate

and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CII definition. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Protected-system boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCIIPC mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** I4C mandate boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sectoral-regulator layer. **Named evidence/example:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** IT Act powers map. **Named evidence/example:** Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Section 66A status. **Named evidence/example:** Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in *Shreya Singhal v. Union of India* in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** DPDP boundary and phases. **Named evidence/example:** The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Resilience-first end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The

conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on 'Evaluate the relationship among cybersecurity, CII protection, cybercrime enforcement and...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Cyber-incident chain. **Named evidence/example:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cybercrime chain. **Named evidence/example:** Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cyber-terrorism law. **Named evidence/example:** Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CII definition. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Protected-system boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCIIPC mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** I4C mandate boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sectoral-regulator layer. **Named evidence/example:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** IT Act powers map. **Named evidence/example:** Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Section 66A status. **Named**

evidence/example: Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in *Shreya Singhal v. Union of India* in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** DPDP boundary and phases. **Named evidence/example:** The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Resilience-first end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
3. **Claim:** Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
4. **Claim:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
5. **Claim:** Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
6. **Claim:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **Named**

evidence/example: Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

7. **Claim:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
8. **Claim:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
9. **Claim:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
10. **Claim:** Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
11. **Claim:** Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in Shreya Singhal v. Union of India in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
12. **Claim:** The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
13. **Claim:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
14. **Claim:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect

threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence.

Qualification: State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Cyber-incident chain. **Named evidence/example:** A cyber incident is a technical security event handled through detection, containment, eradication, recovery and learning; reporting an incident does not prove a crime or foreign operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cybercrime chain. **Named evidence/example:** Cybercrime is a penal offence committed using or against digital systems and follows complaint or registration, investigation, electronic evidence, prosecution and adjudication. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Cyber-terrorism law. **Named evidence/example:** Section 66F of the Information Technology Act defines cyber terrorism around specified acts and terror or sovereignty-related intent; the legal offence is distinct from generic hacking or cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CII definition. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 of the IT Act defines Critical Information Infrastructure by the debilitating consequence that incapacitation or destruction would have for national security, economy, public health or safety. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Protected-system boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Section 70 permits the appropriate government to declare a computer resource affecting CII as a protected system; notification creates legal protection but does not prove resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCIIPC mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70A, the National Critical Information Infrastructure Protection Centre under NTRO is the national nodal agency for CII protection and coordination with protected-system entities. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** CERT-In mandate. **Named evidence/example:** Under Section 70B, CERT-In is the national cyber-incident response agency for alerts, advisories, coordination and emergency response; it is not the police investigator for every cybercrime. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** I4C mandate boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre under MHA supports cybercrime reporting, coordination, capacity and investigation assistance, while State and Union Territory police retain crime-registration and investigation roles. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Sectoral-regulator layer. **Named evidence/example:** Sectoral CERTs, regulators and CII-owning entities have domain-specific resilience responsibilities and must coordinate with CERT-In and NCIIPC rather than transfer all risk to one national body. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** IT Act powers map. **Named evidence/example:** Sections 69, 69A and 69B concern interception or decryption, blocking public access and traffic-data monitoring respectively, each subject to its statutory purpose and prescribed procedure. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Section 66A status. **Named**

evidence/example: Section 66A was struck down by the Supreme Court in *Shreya Singhal v. Union of India* in 2015; it must not be cited as a current offence. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** DPDP boundary and phases. **Named evidence/example:** The DPDP Act, 2023 and Rules, 2025 create a personal-data-governance layer distinct from cybersecurity and CII protection; the Rules notified on 13 November 2025 have staggered commencement rather than full same-day operation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Evidence-status firewall. **Named evidence/example:** A detected event, CERT-In report, citizen complaint, FIR, technical assessment, arrest, charge-sheet, attribution statement, conviction and recovered service are separate evidentiary and operational rungs. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Resilience-first end-state. **Named evidence/example:** Because prevention and attribution are imperfect, India needs identify-protect-detect-respond-recover-learn resilience, tested CII continuity, lawful evidence handling, sectoral accountability and proportionate rights safeguards. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Evaluate the relationship among cybersecurity, CII protection, cybercrime enforcement and...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.